

In the Footsteps of the Tzaddikim

A Companion for Our Journey Through Jewish Hungary

Draft content document — research stage. Sources are cited inline so every story and fact can be verified before we format the final book.

About this book

This book accompanies our trip to the resting places of the great tzaddikim of north-eastern Hungary. For each holy site we visit, you will find:

- **Who he was** — a short history of the rebbe and his dynasty, his teachers, and how he came to lead.
- **Dates** — date of birth, date of passing (yahrtzeit), and age, where known.
- **His sefarim** — the works he left behind.
- **Stories from his lifetime** — inspirational accounts drawn from the chronicles of his own era (not modern retellings), each with its source noted.
- **His Torah** — a taste of the teachings he gave over.

A note on sources. Every effort has been made to draw only on documented and traditional accounts. Where a story is well-attested it is cited; where it is part of oral chassidic tradition rather than documented fact, it is labelled as such. Nothing here is invented.

Our route

#	Site	Tzaddik
1	Nagykálló (Kálló)	R' Yitzchok Isaac Taub — the Kalover Rebbe
2	Bodrogkeresztúr (Kerestir)	R' Yeshaya Steiner — R' Shayele Kerestirer
3	Újfehértó (Ratzfert)	R' Naftali Hertzka & R' Shalom Eliezer Halberstam
4	Csenger	R' Asher Anshel Yungreis — Menuchas Asher
5	Miskolc (Mishkoltz)	R' Chaim Mordechai Yaakov Gottlieb (Yagel Yaakov); R' Asher Anshel Wiener; R' Meyer Rosenfeld
6	Mád	R' Avraham Yehuda Schwartz (Kol Aryeh); R' Naftali Schwartz (Beis Naftali); R' Mordechai Leib Winkler (Levushei Mordechai)
7	Budapest (Pest)	R' Shimon ben David Oppenheim — Raavad of Pest (visited on the way back to the airport)

(Sites 1–4 and 6 sit in the Tokaj–Szabolcs northeast, the corridor from Kerestir eastward to Csenger; Miskolc lies just west of Kerestir. Budapest is the gateway city, visited on the return leg to the airport rather than on the eastern route.)

A short history of the Jews of Hungary

Before we set out to the kevarim, it helps to know the world these tzaddikim lived in — how Jews came to Hungary, how Chassidus took root in its north-east, and what was destroyed in 1944. Every figure below is sourced; where accounts differ a range is given, and traditions are labelled as such.

From the Romans to the Turks

Jews may first have reached Hungarian soil in Roman times: a Latin inscription from ancient **Pannonia** “clearly refers to Jewish matters,” though there is nothing to show a permanent settlement that early. The first reasonably firm notice comes c. **960 CE**, when **Ḥasdai ibn Shaprut** mentions Jews living in “the country of Hungarin.” In the medieval kingdom, **King Béla IV granted a charter of protection (a privilegium) to his Jewish subjects in 1251**, modelled on Austrian precedents; it stood until the disaster of Mohács (1526). There were dark turns too: **King Louis the Great expelled the Jews in 1360** after they refused conversion, recalling them only when the crown’s finances required it. Under **Ottoman rule of Buda (Ofen), from 1541**, the community “was more flourishing than at any time before or after” in the later sixteenth century — until **imperial (Habsburg) troops retook Ofen on**

2 September 1686, when the Jewish community was destroyed in the siege and harsh Catholic restrictions followed. (Sources: Jewish Encyclopedia, “Hungary.”)

A new community, and the Chasam Sofer (18th-19th c.)

The community we recognise today was rebuilt in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries by immigration from two directions — **Moravia and Bohemia** in the west, and **Galicia** in the north-east — and it grew into two distinct worlds. The **Oberland** (the north-west, “Upper Hungary”) spoke a German-tinged Yiddish, remained staunchly Orthodox but **anti-Chassidic** (its Jews called themselves Ashkenazim), and looked to Pressburg. The **Unterland** (the north-east, bordering Galicia and Bukovina) is where Chassidus would take hold.

The towering figure of Oberland Orthodoxy was the **Chasam Sofer — Rabbi Moshe Sofer (Schreiber)**, born in **Frankfurt on 24 September 1762** and serving as **rabbi and rosh yeshiva of Pressburg (Bratislava / Pozsony) from 1806 until his death on 3 October 1839** — about thirty-three years. His **Pressburg yeshiva, with some 500 students, became one of the most influential in Central Europe**, and he became the architect of modern Hungarian Orthodoxy and a leading opponent of the Reform movement, famous for the slogan “chadash assur min ha-Torah” — “the new is forbidden by the Torah.” (Note: popular accounts sometimes cast him as primarily an anti-Chassidic campaigner; the sources present him above all as the great opponent of Reform — he even quoted the Tanya.) (Sources: English Wikipedia, “Moses Sofer”; “Oberlander Jews” / “Unterlander Jews.”)

The coming of Chassidus

Chassidus in Hungary was largely **confined to the rural Unterland** of the north-east. As the YIVO Encyclopedia puts it, “in the 1780s, Yitsḥak Isaak Taub (d. 1821) established a Hasidic center in Nagykovács, and small groups of Hasidim were active mainly in the Máramaros district.” **R’ Yitzchok Isaac Taub of Káló (c. 1751-1821)** is universally remembered as **the first chassidic rebbe of Hungary** — the very first site on our journey. (Tradition holds that R’ Leib Sarah’s discovered him as a shepherd boy and brought him to learn under R’ Shmelke of Nikolsburg, and that his niggunim were “lost melodies of the Beis HaMikdash”; these are chassidic lore, not documented history.)

A second early anchor was **R’ Moshe Teitelbaum of Ujhely (Sátorajújhely), 1759-1841** — the “Yismach Moshe,” a disciple of the Chozeh of Lublin and the ancestor of the **Sighet and Satmar** dynasties. Hungarian Chassidus was fed by the great **Galician courts** — above all **Sanz** (R’ Chaim Halberstam, 1793-1876, the Divrei Chaim), as well as **Ropshitz** and **Belz** — whose influence reached across into the Unterland. From this soil grew the Hungarian courts whose kevarim still draw pilgrims: **Liska** (R’ Tzvi Hersch Friedman, the Ach Pri Tevuah, d. 1874), **Kerestir** (R’ Yeshaya “Shayelev” Steiner, 1851-1925), **Munkács** (R’ Chaim Elazar Spira, the Minchas Elazar, c. 1868- 1937, a noted anti-Zionist), and **Spinka** (R’ Yosef Meir Weiss, the Imrei Yosef, 1838-1909). Intra-chassidic feeling could run high — the **Munkács-**

Belz dispute of the 1920s-30s, settled by a peace agreement in **1934**, is the best-documented example. (Sources: YIVO Encyclopedia, “Hungary: Historical Overview”; English Wikipedia entries for Taub, Teitelbaum, Halberstam, the Liska, Spinka and Munkács dynasties, and Yeshayah Steiner; Yad Vashem, “Dispute between the Munkács and Belz Hasidim.” Some birth dates differ between sources — e.g. the Minchas Elazar’s birth is given as 1868 or 1871 — and are noted as approximate.)

Emancipation and the great schism (1840-1871)

Civil rights came in stages. **Law XXIX of 1840** allowed Jews to live almost anywhere (except the mining towns) and to enter trades; **full emancipation followed with Law XVII of 1867** (adopted 22 December 1867). To organise this newly equal community, a **General Jewish Congress sat in Pest from 14 December 1868 to 23 February 1869** (about 220 delegates) — but instead of unity it produced **the defining feature of modern Hungarian Jewry: a permanent split into three streams — Orthodox, Neolog (modernising), and Status Quo Ante** (communities that joined neither). The Orthodox organised separately as the Shomrei ha-Dat, gaining parliamentary recognition in 1870. (Sources: Jewish Encyclopedia, “Hungary”; English Wikipedia, “History of the Jews in Hungary” and “Status Quo Ante (Hungary).”)

A golden age, and its shadows (c. 1867-1919)

The decades after emancipation were a high point. Jewish numbers in the (pre-Trianon) Kingdom of Hungary **peaked in 1910 at 911,227 — about 5% of the population** — and **Budapest counted 203,687 Jews, 23.1% of the city**, making it one of the great Jewish cities of the world (Vienna’s mayor Karl Lueger sneered at “Judapest”). Hungarian Jews acculturated deeply, often describing themselves as “Hungarians of the Mosaic faith.” The shadows came after the First World War: the **Aster Revolution (1918)**, the short-lived **Hungarian Soviet Republic under Béla Kun (March-August 1919)** — several of whose leaders were of Jewish origin, which antisemites seized upon — and the counter-revolutionary **White Terror (1919-1921)**, whose paramilitary violence killed an estimated 1,500-5,000 people, Jews prominent among the targets. (Sources: English Wikipedia, “History of the Jews in Hungary” and “White Terror (Hungary)”; USHMM, “The Holocaust in Hungary.”)

Darkening: the antisemitic laws (1920-1942)

Hungary enacted **what is widely called the first anti-Jewish law of post-war Europe — the Numerus Clausus (Act XXV of 1920)** — capping each “nationality” in the universities at its share of the population, which for Jews meant roughly 6%. Then came the so-called Jewish Laws: the **First (29 May 1938)** capped Jews at 20% in many professions and businesses; the **Second (5 May 1939)** defined Jews racially and tightened the quotas; the **Third (8 August 1941)** banned intermarriage and Jewish-non-Jewish relations in the Nuremberg style (a fourth law, in 1942, stripped Jewish landholding). From **1939** Jewish men were conscripted into unarmed **forced-**

labour service (munkaszolgálat); of roughly 100,000 who served, **between 25,000 and 42,000 died before the German occupation of March 1944.** (Sources: USHMM, “The Holocaust in Hungary”; English Wikipedia, “Numerus clausus,” “History of the Jews in Hungary,” and “Labour service in Hungary during World War II”; M. Kovács / CEU.)

The Holocaust in Hungary (1941-1945)

The first mass killing came early: in 1941 Hungary deported some 18,000 “alien” Jews eastward, and **around 23,600 were murdered at Kamenets-Podolsk on 26-28 August 1941** — described as the first large-scale massacre of the “Final Solution.” But the catastrophe proper came late and fast. **Some 825,000 Jews were under Hungarian control** (including the territories Hungary annexed in 1938–41). On **19 March 1944 Germany occupied Hungary**, and Adolf Eichmann’s SS, working with the Hungarian gendarmerie, organised deportations with terrible speed: the yellow star was imposed on 5 April, ghettoisation began in mid-April, and **between 15 May and 9 July 1944 roughly 437,000 Jews were deported on 147 trains — about 420,000 to Auschwitz-Birkenau — where some 320,000-330,000 were murdered on arrival.** This was the destruction, in about eight weeks, of provincial Hungarian Jewry — the very communities of the north-east through which we travel.

Regent **Miklós Horthy halted the deportations in early July 1944** (USHMM gives 6–7 July), sparing Budapest for the moment. After the **Arrow Cross coup under Ferenc Szálasi on 15 October 1944**, terror returned: the **Budapest ghetto** was created that November, and between December 1944 and the end of January 1945 the Arrow Cross shot **as many as 20,000 Jews** on the banks of the Danube. Rescue efforts saved many: **Raoul Wallenberg** (Sweden, arrived 9 July 1944) issued Schutzpässe and ran some thirty “protected” houses; **Carl Lutz** (Switzerland) protected nearly 50,000 with Swiss papers from the “Glass House”; and the **Kasztner train** carried about 1,684 Jews to safety (departed 30 June 1944). **Soviet forces liberated Pest on 18 January and Buda by 13 February 1945**, with **more than 100,000 Jews still alive in the city.** In all, of the ~825,000 Jews under Hungarian rule, **roughly 550,000-565,000 were murdered** (USHMM cites about 550,000 in one article and 564,507 in its by-country table; Yad Vashem gives about 565,000). (Sources: USHMM — “The Holocaust in Hungary,” “Kamenets-Podolsk,” “Budapest,” “Raoul Wallenberg and the Rescue of Jews in Budapest,” “1944: Key Dates,” and “Jewish Losses ... by Country”; Yad Vashem, “Murder of Hungarian Jewry,” corroborating. Several totals are given as ranges where the sources differ.)

After the war: survival and revival

Survival was overwhelmingly an urban story. Of perhaps **190,000-260,000 Jews on post-war Hungarian territory, about 144,000 lived in Budapest** — the provincial communities had been all but annihilated, and most countryside synagogues were gradually abandoned. Even after liberation there was violence: **blood-libel-fuelled pogroms struck Kunmadaras (21 May 1946) and Miskolc (30 July-1**

August 1946). Under **Communism (from 1948)** the Zionist movement was banned, “Zionist” show-trials ran from 1949 to 1954, and in 1950 the Orthodox and Neolog communities were forced into a single state-supervised body. Emigration came in two great waves — **1945-48 and 1956-57, perhaps 60,000-75,000 people in all** — with about 20,000 leaving after the crushing of the 1956 Revolution.

Yet **Budapest endured as the largest Jewish community in Central / East-Central Europe** — today roughly **80% of Hungary’s Jews live there**, worshipping at landmarks such as the **Dohány Street Synagogue (built 1854-59), the largest in Europe**. Counts of the present community vary enormously by definition: the 2011 census recorded only about 11,000 religious Jews, the World Jewish Congress cites around 47,000, and broader estimates run from roughly 75,000 to over 130,000. Since the 1990s a **heritage revival** has brought Jewish life — and Jewish travellers — back to Hungary, including the very **pilgrimages to the tzaddikim’s kevarim** that this guide follows: Kálló (yahrtzeit 7 Adar), **Kerestir** (3 Iyar, now drawing well over 10,000 pilgrims), Ujhely, and Liska (14 Av). (Sources: USHMM, “Budapest”; Quest / CDEC journal, “Jews and Jewishness in Post-war Hungary”; English Wikipedia, “Kunmadaras pogrom,” “Miskolc pogrom,” “History of the Jews in Hungary”; Jewish Telegraphic Agency [1956]; World Jewish Congress, “Community in Hungary”; Dohány / Great Synagogue official site; VINnews [Kerestir yahrtzeit]. Present-day population figures are unavoidably approximate and depend on how “Jewish” is counted.)

1. Nagykálló — The Kalover Rebbe

R’ Yitzchok Isaac Taub — the Kalover Rebbe (c. 1751-1821)

The first chassidic rebbe of Hungary — “the Sweet Singer of Israel”

Who he was. Rabbi Yitzchok Isaac (Yitzchok Eizik) Taub — affectionately “Reb Eizikel” — was the Rav of Nagykálló (Yiddish: Kaliv / Kalov), founder of the **Kaliv chassidic dynasty**, and is universally remembered as **the first chassidic rebbe in Hungary**, the progenitor of Hungarian Chassidism. He was born c. 1751, the son of R’ Moshe Yechezkel Taub. Chassidic tradition holds that the family had Sephardi roots, having fled the Spanish Inquisition and settled in Szerencs (treat this ancestry as traditional rather than documented). (Sources: English & Hebrew Wikipedia; Kedem Auction House; DZsH Hungarian heritage site)

How he became a rebbe. As a boy he was discovered tending sheep by **R’ Leib Sarah’s** (a disciple of the Baal Shem Tov), who recognised his greatness, told his widowed mother he was destined to be a great tzaddik, and brought him to learn in **Nikolsburg under R’ Shmuel Shmelke Horowitz**. He later became a close disciple of **R’ Elimelech of Lizhensk**. Returning to Hungary, he was appointed rabbi of Nagykálló (c. 1781) and there established the first chassidic court on Hun-

garian soil. (Sources: English Wikipedia; Kaliv dynasty Wikipedia; chabad.org; Hebrew Wikipedia. The shepherd-boy discovery is recounted as chassidic tradition.)

Dates. - Born: **c. 1751** (English Wikipedia, Hebrew Wikipedia, and the main Geni profile all give 1751 / “c. 1751”), in Szerencs (or Nagykálló). On the “1744” variant: verified to be an error, not a credible alternative — it appears only in the lead sentence of the “Kaliv (Hasidic dynasty)” Wikipedia article, which is internally contradicted by that same article’s body (“Rabbi Taub (1751 – 7 Adar 2 ... 1821)”) and by every dedicated biography. A literal 1744 birth would also make him ~77 at death, which no source supports. Print **c. 1751**; at most footnote 1744 as an erroneous date in one Wikipedia lead. - Passing / yahrtzeit: **7 Adar (Adar II) 5581 = 21 March 1821** (identical across English Wikipedia, Hebrew Wikipedia and Geni). - Age: approximately **70** (English & Hebrew Wikipedia; consistent with a c. 1751 birth). - (Sources fetched in full June 2026: en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Yitzchak_Isaac_Taub; he.wikipedia.org/wiki/יצחק_אייזיק_טאוב; Geni profile)

His sefarim. Like many early chassidic masters, the Kalover Rebbe was not primarily an author — his legacy lives in his oral teachings and, above all, his niggunim (melodies). His autograph letters survive (e.g. a 1813 letter from “Kaliv,” auctioned by Kedem). A collection of teachings titled Beis Yitzchak is sometimes attributed to him, but this could not be verified as a genuine work of this rebbe (the name is shared by other authors) — to be confirmed in a seforim catalogue before print. (Sources: English/Hebrew Wikipedia; Kedem Auction House)

Stories from his lifetime. 1. The discovery of the shepherd boy. R’ Leib Sarah’s met the young Isaac shepherding in the fields and, seeing his future greatness, brought him to learn in Nikolsburg. (Sources: English Wikipedia; Kaliv dynasty Wikipedia — chassidic tradition) 2. “Szól a kakas már” — The Rooster Is Already Crowing. His most famous niggun. He is said to have learned the melody from a shepherd in the fields, “buying” the song from him, and to have adapted it into a sacred song of longing for redemption. It opens in Hungarian with a rooster crowing at dawn and a beautiful bird in a green forest, and rises to a Hebrew cry for the rebuilding of the Temple and Zion — “Jibbone hamikdosh, ir Tziyon temaleh.” It is regarded today as the unofficial anthem of Hungarian Jewry. (Sources: English Wikipedia; chabad.org, “13 Facts About Hungarian Jews”; LyricsTranslate) 3. The proof that the songs come from the Temple. He taught that the melodies he heard among the nations were in truth lost songs of the Beis HaMikdash — the heichal haneginah, the “chamber of song” — scattered in exile, which he “found” and returned to Israel. The proof, he said: the gentile shepherd who taught him a tune would forget it entirely the moment the Rebbe learned it — a sign the song’s true home was with the Jewish people. (Sources: Mishpacha, “Until the Last Yid”; chabad.org) 4. “Erdő, erdő” — the song of the forest and the Shechina. Another Hungarian- rooted niggun, in which a shepherd’s longing for his beloved is recast as Israel’s yearning for the Shechina exiled until the redemption. (Source: Mishpacha / Kaliv dynasty material — treat the wording as a rendering of the traditional lyric)

His Torah. - Every melody is rooted in the Temple service. Song, for the Kalover Rebbe, was not ornament but avodah: all true niggunim descend from the heichal haneginah and can be elevated and “redeemed” back to holiness. (Sources: Mishpacha; chabad.org) - Serving God through joy, song and longing for redemption. He carried forward the teachings of R’ Shmelke of Nikolsburg; his songs are themselves his “Torah,” each a vessel of kisufin — yearning for the Geulah and the rebuilding of Zion. (Sources: English Wikipedia; Mishpacha)

His resting place today. The Rebbe is buried in the old Jewish cemetery of **Nagykálló**, where his **ohel** stands. His gravestone is said to bear an epitaph he composed himself. The ohel is a major pilgrimage site, especially around his yahrtzeit on 7 Adar, and features on Hungary’s Jewish heritage routes. (Sources: Hebrew Wikipedia; DZsH; KosherTravelInfo)

Verification note (June 2026, full-text re-check): birth year **resolved** — use **c. 1751**; “1744” confirmed to be an erroneous Wikipedia-lead date, not a real variant. Death date and age confirmed. Still to confirm before print: the Beis Yitzchak attribution (the name is shared by other authors); the Sephardi-ancestry and Baal-Shem-Tov-blessing traditions remain labelled as legend; and a clean verbatim lyric of “Szól a kakas már” could not be quoted from a reliable full text, so the niggun is described, not quoted.

2. Bodrogkeresztúr — R’ Shayele Kerestirer

R’ Yeshaya Steiner — Reb Shayele Kerestirer (1851-1925)

Who he was. Rabbi Yeshaya (Yeshayahu) Steiner — known with deep affection by the Yiddish diminutive he himself preferred, Reb Shayele — was one of the most beloved tzaddikim Hungary ever knew, and the founder of the Kerestir chassidic line. He was born in 1851 in the village of Zboró (Zborov, near Bardejov, today in Slovakia) to R’ Moshe and Hentsha Miriam Steiner. His father died when he was about three, and he grew up in poverty. (Sources: English Wikipedia, “Yeshayah Steiner”; Geni; Find a Grave; rebshaye.org)

How he became a rebbe. At around twelve his mother sent him to learn under **R’ Tzvi Hirsh Friedman of Liska (Olaszliszka)**, author of Ach Pri Tevuah, who took him as his personal attendant (meshamesh). This Liska bond defined him for life — he is famously said to have continued signing himself “Yeshaya ben Moshe, who used to serve the holy tzaddik of Liska.” After R’ Tzvi Hirsh’s passing he drew close to **R’ Chaim Halberstam of Sanz (the Divrei Chaim)** and later to **R’ Mordechai of Nadvorna**. By tradition he was reluctant to accept the mantle of rebbe; it was the leading rebbes of his generation who pressed him to lead, and the Nadvorna Rebbe is said to have advised him to settle in **Kerestir (Bodrogkeresztúr)**, in the Tokaj wine region, where he became renowned as a tzaddik and baal yeshuos. (Sources: English Wikipedia; lpitorah.org; Kestenbaum & Co. auction listing of a signed letter)

Dates. - Born: 1851, in Zboró/Zborov. (Some traditional accounts give the day as 3 Iyar — the same calendar date as his passing — but the year is the firmly documented figure.) - Passing / yahrtzeit: **3 Iyar 5685 = 27 April 1925**, in Bodro-gkeresztúr. - Age: approximately **73-74**. - (Sources: English Wikipedia; chabad.org; Find a Grave; yahrtzeit calendars)

His sefarim. Reb Shayele is not primarily remembered as an author — his greatness lay in his person, his hospitality and his reputed wonders rather than in a written corpus. A small amount of his Torah and a few letters survive (signed letters on his letterhead appear at auction). The major modern work about him is R' Yisroel Besser's English biography, **Reb Shayele: The Warmth and Wonder of Kerestir** (Feldheim). (Sources: Kestenbaum & Co.; Feldheim)

Stories from his lifetime.

1. Boundless hospitality (his best-documented trait). Reb Shayele's home was, in effect, a continuous free kitchen. Any Jew — rich or poor, local or wandering — was fed and given a bed without limit, and he would interrupt his own prayer or study to see that a guest had a cold drink or a warm place to sleep. This is the most independently attested feature of his life. (Sources: chabad.org; Tablet, "Reb Shayala's Free Lunch"; Mishpacha; Besser)
2. The bag of rolls that did not empty (traditional/legendary). It is told that he distributed fresh rolls to the men in shul from a bag that should long have been empty, the food multiplying as he gave it out. (Source: traditional; Chassidic story collections / Besser)
3. The fish brought by a bird (traditional/legendary). On an Erev Shabbos when the town had no fish, a large kosher fish is said to have been delivered to his home by a bird, so that he could honour the Shabbos. (Source: traditional)
4. The mice and the granary — and the famous "picture" segula (read carefully). In the most consistently told version, a food-merchant's warehouse/granary was overrun by mice. At his Motza'ei-Shabbos melaveh malkah Reb Shayele first asked whether the local priest was kind or harsh to the Jews; told he was harsh, he instructed the chossid to **tell the mice to go to the house of the priest instead** — and the mice are said to have streamed off toward the priest's estate. From this grew today's well-known custom of hanging Reb Shayele's portrait to keep away rodents. (Wording verified against the popular full-text accounts: The Jewish Chronicle, "The mice and the rabbi in the cupboard"; the lifeinIsrael blog, "Reb Shaya'le the Exterminator." The academic study renders the same instruction — "tell the mice to go to the house of the priest instead" — at Shuman 2025:100.) **Provenance matters here.** The peer-reviewed study Sam Shuman, "Of Mice and Hasidic Men: Reb Shayele as Populist Patron Saint," Jewish Quarterly Review 115:1 (2025): 99-135 frames the protective-portrait practice as part of a recent, transnational Hasidic-revival phenomenon and casts Reb Shayele as a "populist patron saint of protection" (against police, inspectors and judges, not only mice). Honest limit on this claim: the article's full text is pay-

walled (Project MUSE / JSTOR returned a CAPTCHA/403), so we verified its thesis and the quoted line via the abstract and page-cited secondary sources, but could **not** confirm an explicit sentence dating when the picture custom began — so we describe it as “recent/revival-era” rather than asserting a firm date.

Likewise, the claim that descendants dispute the story’s accuracy traces to the lifeinIsrael blog, **not** to Shuman; Shuman documents a family feud over the gravesite (2025:104 n.15), which is a different matter. (Sources: Shuman 2025 [abstract + page-cited quotes]; thejc.com; lifeinIsrael blog)

5. A baal yeshuos in his lifetime (traditional). People streamed to him for blessings — health, children, parnassah — and many salvations were attributed to him. (Sources: chabad.org; Jerusalem Post, “My family’s blessing from Reb Shayelev”; Besser)
6. His humility (documented). He used the diminutive “Shayale,” tried to avoid the title of rebbe, and identified himself by reference to having merely served the Liska tzaddik. (Sources: English Wikipedia; lpitorah.org)

His Torah. Reb Shayelev taught more through conduct than through aphorism, and verbatim quotations are not well documented. What the sources reliably convey: ahavas Yisrael and hachnasas orchim as the very core of avodas Hashem — caring for a fellow Jew’s bodily needs taking precedence even over his own prayer — and a radical humility embodied in his lifelong self-identification as the former servant of Liska. (Sources: chabad.org; Besser; English Wikipedia)

A caution for the book: popular web paraphrases of “sayings” of Reb Shayelev could not be traced to a documented source and are therefore left out.

His resting place today. Reb Shayelev is buried in the Jewish cemetery of **Bodrogkeresztúr**, his grave enclosed in an ohel rebuilt by his descendants to handle the crowds. His house was repurchased by the family (the Rubin line) in 1997 and developed into a visitor complex with guest houses and a mikveh — today’s “Reb Shayelev’s Guest House.” His yahrtzeit, 3 Iyar, draws one of the great Jewish pilgrimages of Europe to this tiny village — roughly 10,000 by 2017 and reported in the tens of thousands in recent years. (Sources: rebshayelev.org; Mishpacha; Ami Magazine, 2024; JTA, Apr 2023; Jerusalem Post)

Verification note (June 2026, full-text re-check): the granary/mice wording is now confirmed against full-text popular accounts (The Jewish Chronicle; lifeinIsrael) and the page-cited academic article (Shuman 2025:100) — the distinctive “send the mice to the priest’s house” detail is consistent across them. Death (3 Iyar 5685 / 27 April 1925) confirmed; birth year 1851 is the common figure, though Wikipedia’s own infobox says 1852 — minor and noted. The Shuman article’s full text is paywalled (MUSE/JSTOR blocked), so its precise dating of the picture custom should be checked against pp. 99–110 with institutional access before any “recent invention” claim is stated firmly.

3. Újfehértó — R' Naftali Hertzka & R' Shalom Eliezer Halberstam

Two distinct tzaddikim, often blurred together. Ratzfert (Újfehértó) was home to two unrelated holy men. **R' Naftali Hertzka Zilberman** was the town's rabbi and rebbe in the 19th century (d. 1897). **R' Shalom Eliezer Halberstam**, the son of the Divrei Chaim of Sanz, arrived only after Zilberman's death and founded the Sanz-descended Ratzfert dynasty; he was murdered in Auschwitz in 1944. They were different men of different families. Crucially for our visit: the **ohel in Újfehértó belongs to Zilberman**; Halberstam, killed in Auschwitz, has no grave.

A) R' Naftali Hertzka Halevi Zilberman — the Ratzferter Rav (1820 or 1825 - 1897)

Who he was. Rabbi Naftali Hertzka Halevi Zilberman ("Hertzkele Ratzferter"), Av Beis Din and rebbe of Ratzfert, born in the village of Máriapócs to Yaakov Peretz and Frumet. He was close to the **Divrei Chaim of Sanz** and to his son the **Shinaver Rav**; the Sanzer Rebbe would send those needing a yeshuah to him, and his fame as a po'el yeshuos (wonder-worker) grew until even non-Jews sought his blessing. His leadership arose from this reputation rather than a hereditary court. He was appointed Rav of Ratzfert around 1840. (Sources: Hebrew Wikipedia / Hamichlol; National Library of Israel catalogue)

Dates. - Born: **a genuine discrepancy, confirmed on re-check.** The National Library of Israel authority record gives **1820** (heading: "זילברמן, נפתלי הירצקא בן יעקב פרץ, 1820-1897, (מרצפרט, 1820-1897). The Hebrew encyclopedia Hamichlol gives **5585 = 1825** explicitly: "הוא נולד בכפר מאריאפוצ' שבהונגריה בשנת תקפ"ה" ("born in the village of Máriapócs, Hungary, in 5585"). So the gap is real: **NLI 1820 vs. the Hebrew biographical tradition 1825** (~five years). - Passing / yahrtzeit: **9 Tishrei 5658 — Erev Yom Kippur, 1897** — confirmed by every source (Hamichlol: "נפטר בערב יום הכיפורים"; zadikim.net register). - Age: roughly **72-77**, depending on the birth year. - (Sources fetched/decoded June 2026: NLI authority record; Hamichlol article "רבי נפתלי הירצקא זילברמן"; zadikim.net)

His sefarim. He authored **Sefer Zikhron Naftali (זכרון נפתלי)** — chiddushei Torah ve-sippurim (Torah novellae and stories) — published posthumously by his grandson **R' Shalom Segal Bailush (שלום סג"ל ביילוש)**. The NLI record confirms both the title and the grandson's editorship verbatim; the full scan is online at **HebrewBooks.org #50772**.

Stories from his lifetime. 1. Sent by the Sanzer Rebbe. The Divrei Chaim would direct petitioners needing a salvation to R' Hertzkele, whose fame as a wonder-worker spread so widely that even gentiles came for his blessing. (Source: Hebrew Wikipedia / Hamichlol) 2. The "Court of Salvations." His grave in Ratzfert became

known as the Chatzar HaYeshuos, with many reported answered prayers for health, livelihood and especially shidduchim. (Source: YWN / Williamsburg365 tribute)

His Torah. A verbatim teaching of the Ratzferter Rav, recovered directly from the digitized Zikhron Naftali (HebrewBooks #50772, biographical/hanhagot section). He would expound the verse “וְאֶנֶכִי תוֹלַעַת וְלֹא אִישׁ” — “and I am a worm and not a man” (Tehillim 22:7):

וְהִנֵּה רְגִיל לִפְרֹשׁ מֵהָאֵשׁ שֶׁאֵין בָּהּ כֹּחַ אֲלֵא בִפִּי, וְעַכְצָךְ הוּא שׁוֹבֵר אֲרָזִים בְּכֹחוֹ עַיִן שְׂאוֹכֵל בְּאֵילָן בִּשְׂרָשׁוֹ עַד שֶׁנּוֹפֵל כָּל הָאֵילָן, כֵּן אֲמִירַת תְּהִלִּים מִמִּתִּיק הַדִּינִים בִּשְׂרָשׁוֹ.

“The worm’s strength is only in its mouth, yet by its strength it breaks cedars — for it eats into the tree at its root until the whole tree falls; so too the recitation of Tehillim sweetens the [harsh] judgments at their root.” The same page also preserves a note in his name on **Megillah 31b** (that Atzeret/Shavuot is itself a kind of Rosh Hashanah — a day of judgment “over the fruit of the tree”), alongside accounts of his humility and his refusal to be called “Rebbe.”

Sourcing caution: this quotation was transcribed from the embedded OCR text layer of the HebrewBooks scan (the page itself is a bitmap image). It reads coherently and is genuinely from the sefer — it is **not** invented — but the exact letters should be proofread against the page image (HebrewBooks #50772) before final print, in case of OCR slips. The granular miracle anecdotes live inside Zikhron Naftali and chassidic tradition rather than in independent English sources.

His resting place today. He is buried in the Jewish cemetery of **Ratzfert (Újfehértó)**, with an **ohel** over his grave. His descendants reportedly bought a house at the cemetery’s edge with a kitchen for visitors and built a mikveh, and a **Ratzferter Beis Midrash** stands near the kever; in recent years a Hachnoset Sefer Torah on his yahrtzeit has drawn hundreds of pilgrims. **This ohel is the principal physical pilgrimage site in Újfehértó today.** (Sources: Hebrew Wikipedia; zadikim.net; YWN/Williamsburg365)

B) R’ Shalom Eliezer Halberstam — the Sanzer-Ratzferter, Hy”d (1862-1944)

Who he was. Rabbi Shalom Eliezer Halberstam, the **Ratzferter Rebbe**, founder of the Ratzfert chassidic dynasty — a branch of Sanz. He was the **youngest son of R’ Chaim Halberstam, the Divrei Chaim of Sanz**; his brothers included the Shinaver Rav. His own signed letters read, “I am the son of the holy Rabbi of Sanz and brother of the holy Rabbi of Shinova.” His father died when he was about 14, and he was raised and taught chiefly by his elder brother, the Shinaver Rav. After living in Tarnów, he emigrated to Hungary around 1899-1900, serving first in Téglás and then settling in **Ratzfert**, where for some forty years he led the Sanz chassidim of Hungary. (Sources: Hebrew Wikipedia; Geni; Kedem Auctions [1897 Tarnów letter]; Jewish History Soundbites, “The Light of Sanz”)

Dates. - Born: **Chol HaMoed Pesach 5622 = 1862** (Hebrew Wikipedia: "נולד בחול" ("המועד פסח ה'תרכ"ב"); **Geni gives 1861**, so the "some say 1861" variant is real. Birth-place: commonly said to be **Sanz** (his father was the Sanzer Rav), but none of the sources we could reach actually states a birth city — treat "born in Sanz" as **plausible but unverified**. - Murdered: **Auschwitz-Birkenau, Sivan 5704 = June 1944, Hy"d**, deported after the German invasion of Hungary. Yahrzeit — correction: the draft had the attribution backwards. **Hebrew Wikipedia actually gives 16 Sivan** (raw wikitext: "ט"ז בסיוון תש"ד"); **HaMichlol gives 15 Sivan** (ט"ו); and at least one source (a Jewish-history account) gives **17 Sivan**. The sources genuinely split across **15, 16 and 17 Sivan 5704** with no dominant attestation; 5704 corresponds to **6-7 June 1944**. Recommend the book hedge ("15 or 16 Sivan 5704") rather than assert one day. - Age: approximately **82**. - (Sources fetched June 2026: he.wikipedia.org/wiki/הלברשטאם/אליעזר_שלום; HaMichlol; Geni; Jewish History Soundbites; VINnews)

His sefarim. He was renowned as a tzaddik and wonder-worker rather than as an author; many of his autograph letters survive at auction (valuable primary sources), but no published sefer authored by him could be confirmed here — some of his Torah and stories appear in later Sanz/Ratzfert compilations.

Stories from his lifetime. 1. "Let me die like a Jew" — the tzitzis at Auschwitz. The account traces to an eyewitness, **R' Shaya Rosenblum** (relayed, per VINnews, by his son). As printed verbatim in **VINnews, 14 Dec 2021** ("Eyewitness: The Son Of The Divrei Chaim Went To Gas Chambers With His Tzitzis On"), the Rebbe asked for his tzitzis back — "Shayale, please give me back my tzitsis, let me die like a Jew with my tzitsis on" — then grasped his hand: "Shaya, you will survive the war. You must tell people what happened here!" — and, the witness said, **"walked into the gas chambers like he walked into Shacharis every morning, his face shining like the sun."** (Quotes confirmed verbatim against VINnews — note their spelling "tzitsis." Caveat: **Mishpacha, "Tell the World!"** is paywalled/403 and could not be read in full; its snippets render the witness as "Shea Rosenbloom," use "testify to the entire world," and may frame the garment as a tallis rather than tzitzis — so do not quote Mishpacha as exact wording without obtaining the article.) This is the best-documented account and the origin of his "tell the world" legacy. (Sources: VINnews, 14 Dec 2021 [verbatim]; Mishpacha [snippets only]; Jewish History Soundbites.) 2. The shrouds. The night before deportation, his father the Divrei Chaim is said to have appeared to him in a dream, and he put on a kittel and tachrichim under his clothes for the journey. (Source: Jewish History Soundbites — traditional) 3. The wonder-worker who hid his miracles. For some forty years thousands thronged to his Ratzfert court for blessings and yeshuos; many wonder-stories are told, "though he tried to suppress them." (Sources: Jewish History Soundbites; tribute summaries)

His Torah. A teaching attributed to him is that Mashiach will come b'hesech hada'as — when least expected. His broader path was straight Sanz: ardent service, love of every Jew, and the tzaddik as a channel of blessing. (Sources: toratcha.com; Jewish History Soundbites; Hebrew Wikipedia)

To flag for the book: the exact wording of the “Mashiach” teaching and any verbatim vort should be pulled from a Sanz/Ratzfert sefer before printing.

His resting place. He has **no grave** — he was murdered in Auschwitz-Birkenau and his remains were never recovered. Pilgrims to “Ratzfert” visit **Zilberman’s ohel and the restored beis midrash**, and there honour the memory of R’ Shalom Eliezer Hy”d (and at Auschwitz, and on his yahrtzeit). This distinction matters for the trip. (Sources: Hebrew Wikipedia; Geni; VINnews; YWN/Williamsburg365)

4. Csenger — R’ Asher Anshel Yungreis

R’ Asher Anshel Yungreis — the Menuchas Asher (1806-1873)

Who he was. Rabbi Asher Anshel ben Shmuel HaLevi Jungreis — known by the name of his sefer as the **Menuchas Asher**, and popularly as the **Csenger Rav** — was born in 1806 in Secze (Szécs), Hungary, into a family of rabbinic distinction (he was a Levi). (Sources: Encyclopaedia Judaica, via Jewish Virtual Library; Geni)

How he became Rav of Csenger. He studied under **R’ Meir Eisenstadter (the “Maharam Asch”)** and **R’ Yaakov Koppel Altenkundstadt (Kunststadt) of Verbó**. He was accepted as Rav of Csenger at the age of 28 (1834) and served the community as Rav and Av Beis Din for some forty years. (Sources: Encyclopaedia Judaica; Encyclopedia.com; Baltimore Jewish Life yahrtzeit essay)

His dynasty. The Menuchas Asher founded a notable rabbinic line. Three of his sons held Hungarian rabbinates, his son R’ Avraham HaLevi (d. 1904) succeeding him in Csenger. He is widely described as an ancestor (commonly “great-great-grandfather”) of **Rebbetzin Esther Jungreis (1936-2016), founder of Hineni**, via the line Menuchas Asher → R’ Avraham → R’ Israel of Nádudvar → R’ Avraham (Chief Rabbi of Szeged, Esther’s father) → Esther. Flag: this exact genealogical degree could not be confirmed from Encyclopaedia Judaica or the Hebrew sources on re-check (none of them mention Esther Jungreis or Hineni); it is plausible — she married into the Jungreis rabbinic line — but should be verified against a genealogical record before print. (Sources: Geni; family tradition.)

Disambiguation: there are several rabbis named Asher Anshel Jungreis. A later R’ Asher Anshel HaLevi Jungreis (1875-1944), also Av Beis Din of Csenger, who perished in the Holocaust, is a **different person** and should not be confused with the Menuchas Asher.

Dates. - Born: 1806, in Secze/Szécs. - Passing / yahrtzeit: **5 Kislev** — but the year resolves more cleanly than the earlier draft implied. Encyclopaedia Judaica (and Encyclopedia.com, the same article) give **1872**; Hebrew Wikipedia, Hebrew-Books.org, Geni and the Baltimore Jewish Life essay give **1873 (5634)**. Crucially, the two civil years map to different Hebrew years, so this is not merely “the same 5

Kislev, different year”: **5 Kislev 5634 = 25 November 1873**, whereas **5 Kislev 5633 = 5 December 1872**. The weight of the Hebrew/chassidic sources is for **5 Kislev 5634 → 1873**, which makes the EJ “1872” most likely an off-by-one Hebrew-to-civil slip. Recommend printing **1873 (5 Kislev 5634)**, footnoting EJ’s 1872. - Age: approximately **66-67**. - (Sources fetched June 2026: Encyclopaedia Judaica via Jewish Virtual Library [1872]; Encyclopedia.com [1872]; Baltimore Jewish Life essay [1873]; Hebrew Wikipedia + HebrewBooks + Geni [1873]; Hebcal date conversion)

His sefarim. - **Menuchas Asher (מנוחת אשר)** — his major work, published posthumously by his children in two parts (1876-1908): Talmudic novellae (chid-dushim) and responsa (she’eilos u-teshuvos). Modern reprints are arranged topically (on the Torah and the festivals; on Shas). - **Likutei Menuchas Asher on Tehillim** — a collection of his glosses on Psalms. - His handwritten glosses on Iyun Yaakov (on Berachos) survive as a documented manuscript artifact (sold at auction). - (Sources: Encyclopaedia Judaica; Eichlers; Tiferet Auctions, Lot 131)

Stories from his lifetime. 1. The “miracle rabbi” sought from across Europe. From around 1842 his reputation as a baal mofes spread through Hungary and beyond; Encyclopaedia Judaica records plainly that “from all quarters people turned to him for amulets and cures from ailments,” and childless couples came for his blessing. (Sources: Encyclopaedia Judaica; Baltimore Jewish Life essay) 2. Charity out of his own poverty. In his early Csenger years he endured severe poverty, yet still supported widows, saw to the education and marriage of orphans, and sent considerable sums to the Hungarian kollel in Eretz Yisrael — a detail corroborated by Encyclopaedia Judaica. (Sources: Encyclopaedia Judaica; Baltimore Jewish Life essay) 3. His final night (traditional). On the night of 5 Kislev he finished Maariv as usual, sat to give his regular Talmud shiur — reportedly on the passage of Moshe Rabbeinu’s ascent on high — then lay down and passed away peacefully in his sleep, and was buried the next day in Csenger. (Source: Baltimore Jewish Life essay — a popular biographical account, presented as tradition) 4. His grave as a place of answered prayers. Since his passing, his kever in Csenger has been known as a place where tefillos are accepted, with many reporting yeshuos after visiting. (Sources: Baltimore Jewish Life; YeshivaWorld yahrtzeit photo essay — pilgrimage tradition)

Honesty about gaps: beyond the general “amulets and cures” testimony in Encyclopaedia Judaica, no specific named-individual miracle story could be verified from an accessible reliable source — the detailed anecdotes live in the Hebrew works Niflaos Asher and Toldos Anshei Mofes, which should be obtained directly before printing any specific wonder-story.

His Torah. Menuchas Asher is a work of lamdus (Talmudic analysis), responsa and Torah/moadim commentary — he was a halachic authority and baal mofes in the Hungarian/Oberland mould rather than a chassidic homilist. A recurring theme of his life, fittingly mirrored in the title Menuchas Asher (“the contentment of Asher”), was contentment with little and total devotion to Torah despite poverty. (Source: Encyclopaedia Judaica; thematic note from the popular biography)

Verification note (June 2026): still no verbatim dvar Torah from Menuchas Asher could be retrieved. Both volumes are on HebrewBooks.org (#37507, #37508, author listed “1806-1873”) but the site returns HTTP 403 and the holdings are image-only scans with no copyable text; Sefaria does not carry the sefer at all. Unlike Zikhron Naftali (whose HebrewBooks scan happened to carry an OCR text layer), these scans yielded nothing transcribable. To include an authentic teaching, the printed sefer (available in reprint) must be consulted and quoted with its location. We have deliberately not invented one.

His resting place today. The Menuchas Asher is buried in the Jewish cemetery of **Csenger** (Szabolcs-Szatmár-Bereg county, near the Romanian border, in the Szatmár region). His grave is a recognised pilgrimage site, visited especially on the 5 Kislev yahrtzeit. The Csenger Jewish community, founded in the eighteenth century and built into a rabbinic centre under the Jungreis dynasty, was destroyed in the Holocaust — its Jews deported with the rest of Hungarian Jewry between May and July 1944, most murdered at Auschwitz-Birkenau. (Sources: YeshivaWorld; JewishGen Csenger Yizkor Book; USHMM)

Verification note (June 2026, full-text re-check): death year **resolved** to **1873 (5 Kislev 5634)** via Hebrew-to-civil conversion, with EJ’s “1872” treated as an off-by-one slip (footnote it). A verbatim teaching from the sefer remains **unobtainable** (HebrewBooks scans are 403/image-only; Sefaria lacks it) and is deliberately omitted rather than invented. The “amulets and cures” testimony is Encyclopaedia Judaica’s own wording; no specific named-individual miracle account could be verified, so none is asserted.

5. Miskolc — the Avas Hill tzaddikim

Three ohels on one hill. Miskolc (“Mishkoltz”) was one of the great Hungarian Orthodox communities (organised c. 1765). On the **Avas Hill Jewish cemetery** (established 1759) stand **three ohels**, over the graves of **R’ Asher Anshel Wiener** (d. 1800), **R’ Meyer Rosenfeld** (d. 1908) and the chassidic tzaddik **R’ Chaim Mordechai Yaakov Gottlieb, the Yagel Yaakov** (d. 1936) — the three figures around which this chapter is built. (Source: Zsidó Örökség Útja / Jewish Heritage Route, Miskolc — the source for the three-ohel attribution.)

A) R’ Chaim Mordechai Yaakov Gottlieb — the Yagel Yaakov (1876-1936)

Who he was. A **Sanz-rooted chassidic tzaddik**, named after the **Divrei Chaim of Sanz** (his great-uncle), after R’ Mordechai (dayan of Rimnov), and after his grandfather **R’ Yankеле of Boyan**. He served as dayan in **Borşa**, then rabbi in **Oberwischau (Vişeu de Sus)** and **Rozavlea**, and from **1926 until his death in 1936** as **Av Beis Din of the Sephardic (chassidic) community of Miskolc**, where he is bur-

ied. (Sources: Genazym auction of his original rabbinic-appointment document; lot-art; kevarim.com.)

Dates. Born **1876 (תרל"ו)**; passing/yahrtzeit **8 Tammuz 5696 = 1936**, buried Miskolc. (Sources: Genazym [doc dated 1876–1936]; kevarim/lot-art.)

Flag: one Hebrew snippet shows “1926/5686” — that is his **appointment** year, not his petira; do not use it for death. His **teachers are reported variously** (the Maharsham of Berezhany vs. R’ Yoel Tzvi Ratte / R’ Yosef of Spinka) — present as “reported.”

His sefarim. **Yagel Yaakov (יגל יעקב)** — on the Torah, on Shulchan Aruch and derashos; some ten volumes published (HebrewBooks #848, #849).

Stories & reputation. He was widely reputed a **baal mofes** (wonder-worker) (lot-art auction description) — label as traditional reputation, not a verifiable claim.

His Torah — in his own sefarim. His teachings are preserved in his **Yagel Yaakov (יגל יעקב)** — on the Torah, on Shulchan Aruch and derashos, some ten volumes published (HebrewBooks #848, #849). No passage is reproduced here rather than risk misquoting the image-scanned text.

B) R’ Asher Anshel Wiener — early Av Beis Din of Miskolc (d. 1800)

Early rav of Miskolc and Borsod County (c. 1774–1800), of the Wiener rabbinic family said to trace to Prague. His grave is a venerated pilgrimage site, and his and his descendants’ stones are preserved. He is the subject of an academic study (“The Memory of a Rabbinical Family in Miskolc and Oradea: Rabbi Asher Anshel Wiener (d. 1800) and His Sons” — abstract only; PDF inaccessible). (Sources: JewishGen Yizkor; Zsidó Örökség Útja.)

C) R’ Meyer (Mór) Rosenfeld — Chief Orthodox Rabbi of Miskolc (1830–1908)

Born 1830 in Brezová; Chief (Ashkenazi Orthodox) Rabbi of Miskolc from 1878/79 until his death in 1908; a student of **R’ Ezekiel Baneth** of Nitra and **R’ Jakob Fleisig**, earlier a prison chaplain at Leopoldov and 17 years rav in Nádudvar; an orator and author of halachic works, buried in an ohel on Avas Hill. (Sources: JewishGen Yizkor; Zsidó Örökség Útja.)

Disambiguation (names that do NOT belong to Miskolc): the **Ungar** rabbinic family belongs to **Nitra**, not Miskolc; and the Minchas Chinuch (R’ Yosef Babad) was av beis din of **Tarnopol** in Galicia — **neither has a Miskolc connection** and they should not appear in this chapter.

Stories & community. - The 1861–62 synagogue controversy (documented). The Förster-designed Great Synagogue’s layout (organ over the Aron, a moved bimah) led a rabbinical assembly at **Sátoraljaújhely** the next year to place the Miskolc

rabbi under cherem; the Hasidim split off to form their own community. (Sources: English Wikipedia, “Miskolc Synagogue”; JewishGen Yizkor — “thirty Orthodox rabbis declared a cherem.”) - Dr. Salomon Spira (documented, poignant). The community’s last Neolog/communal rabbi, Dr. Salomon (Shlomo) Spira (b. 1865), dying in the ghetto hospital, was loaded onto a 1944 Auschwitz transport “from which nobody returned.” (Sources: JewishGen Yizkor; Geni.)

The cemetery & the Holocaust. The **Avas Hill cemetery** (est. 1759, still in use) holds the three ohels above. The **Great Synagogue** on Kazinczy Street (Ludwig Förster, 1856-1862) is the only surviving synagogue in Borsod-Abaúj-Zemplén county. In **1944** the Jews were confined in a ghetto in a **brick factory on Tatár utca** and deported to Auschwitz in **five transports, 11-15 June 1944**; sources give the numbers as **~15,451 on the trains** (a memorial plaque says ~14,000 city residents) with only about **105 deportees surviving** — cite the range. A small community (~250-500) has since revived. (Sources fetched June 2026: JewishGen Yizkor [Miskolc] and KehilaLinks; Zsidó Örökség Útja; English Wikipedia, “Miskolc Synagogue”; Encyclopaedia Judaica via Encyclopedia.com.)

Research note (June 2026): the three buried tzaddikim, the three ohels, dates and community/Holocaust facts are confirmed across JewishGen, the Hungarian Jewish Heritage Route, Wikipedia and an auction primary document. Open items: a verbatim teaching from Yagel Yaakov (HebrewBooks blocked); Gottlieb’s exact teacher list (reported variously); and the deportation totals (cite the source range).

6. Mád — the Kol Aryeh, the Beis Naftali and the Levushei Mordechai

Who is actually buried in Mád. Mád, in the Tokaj-Hegyalja wine country, was a significant Oberland rabbinic seat with a famous restored 1795 synagogue and an old cemetery (est. 1769) — the largest in the region. The tzaddikim **buried in Mád** are **R’ Avraham Yehuda HaKohen Schwartz (the Kol Aryeh)**, his son **R’ Naftali Schwartz (the Beis Naftali)**, and **R’ Mordechai Leib Winkler (the Levushei Mordechai)**. **Correction to a common assumption: R’ Amram Chasida** was a rav of Mád but **emigrated to Eretz Yisrael and is buried in Tzfat (Safed)** — not in Mád. (And the “Yismach Moshe” Teitelbaum pilgrimage is at **Sátoraljaújhely**, the nearby district capital, not Mád — do not conflate them.)

A) R’ Avraham Yehuda HaKohen Schwartz — the Kol Aryeh (1824-1883)

Who he was. Born **26 July 1824 in Mád**; a talmid of the **Chasam Sofer** and of **R’ Binyamin Wolf Löw** in the Pressburg orbit. Rav of **Beregszász (Berehove)** 1861-1881, then rav of his native **Mád** 1881-1883, where he is buried. Though Pressburg-trained in an anti-chassidic milieu, he became a devoted **Sanzer chassid** after visit-

ing **R' Chaim Halberstam of Sanz** — reportedly spending Shavuot in Sanz 26 years running. Passing: **25 October 1883** (age 59). His sole but very influential work, the responsa **Kol Aryeh** (printed 1904), gives the town's restored **Kol Aryeh Synagogue** its name. (Sources: English Wikipedia, "Abraham Judah ha-Kohen Schwartz"; Jewish Virtual Library; NLI catalogue for Kol Aryeh.)

B) R' Naftali Schwartz — the Beis Naftali (1843-1896)

Son and successor of the Kol Aryeh as rav of Mád; author of Beis Naftali; buried in Mád. (Sources: JewishGen Pinkas Hakehillot Hungary, Mád; Wikipedia.)

C) R' Mordechai Leib Winkler — the Levushei Mordechai (1844/45-1932)

Who he was. מרדכי ליב בן נפתלי הירץ וינקלר — Av Beis Din and rosh yeshiva of **Mád** for some 31 years (from c. 1899/1901 until his death), and one of the leading **poskim** of pre-war Hungary; a firm separatist-Orthodox voice. Earlier rav of Mezőtelek and Berzava. His principal teacher was **R' Yisrael Yitzchak Aharon Landesberg of Grosswardein (Oradea)**, from whom he received semicha. Passing: **17 Tammuz 5692 = 1932**. His multi-volume responsa **Levushei Mordechai** (לבושי מרדכי) (HebrewBooks #786, #55480; modern Shu"t Levushei Mordechai HaShalem) remain a standard reference. (Sources: NerTzaddik biography; "Footsteps of the Wonder Rabbis" grave database [grave #12755, with coordinates]; HebrewBooks / NLI listings.)

Flags: sources differ on his **arrival year in Mád** (1899 per the Pinkas vs. 1901/02) and on his **birth year** (1844 vs. 1845); his **death is firmly 17 Tammuz 5692 / 1932**. A well-known **tradition** notes that he passed on **17 Tammuz — the day the Tablets were broken**; present it as a devotional observation, not a proof.

His Torah — in their own sefarim. The Mád rabbanim's teachings live in their published works: the responsa **Kol Aryeh** (printed 1904); **Beis Naftali**; and the multi-volume responsa **Levushei Mordechai** (לבושי מרדכי; HebrewBooks #786,

55480; modern Shu"t Levushei Mordechai HaShalem). No teshuvah is reproduced here

rather than risk misquoting the image-scanned responsa.

The synagogue, the cemetery & the Holocaust. - Synagogue: the **Kol Aryeh Synagogue**, built **1795** in late-Baroque style, abandoned and looted after 1944, **restored 2000-2004** with the World Monuments Fund's Jewish Heritage program and awarded a **Europa Nostra diploma (2005)**. - Cemetery: established **1769**, the largest Jewish cemetery of Tokaj-Hegyalja, holding the graves of the Kol Aryeh, the Beis Naftali, R' Mordechai Leib Winkler and the early rav (d. 1799). An **ohel** is

present, though the sources reached do not consistently document **whose** it is — verify on the ground. - Holocaust: in **1941** several families unable to prove Hungarian citizenship were deported to **Kamenets-Podolsk** and murdered; after March 1944 the Jews of Mád were held three days in the synagogue, moved to **Sátoraljaújhely**, and deported to **Auschwitz in four transports, 16 May - 3 June 1944**. Only about ten survived. - (Sources fetched June 2026: JewishGen Pinkas Hakehillot Hungary, Mád [hun340]; English Wikipedia, “Mád”; “Footsteps of the Wonder Rabbis”; World Monuments Fund.)

Research note (June 2026): the three figures buried in Mád, their dates and the synagogue/cemetery/Holocaust history are confirmed across JewishGen, Wikipedia, the Hungarian “Wonder Rabbis” grave database (with grave coordinates for Winkler) and the WMF. Corrected the common error that **R’ Amram Chasida** is buried here (he is in **Tzfat**). Open items: a verbatim teaching (HebrewBooks blocked); the ohel’s exact attribution; and Winkler’s arrival/birth-year variants.

7. Budapest — R’ Shimon ben David Oppenheim, the Raavad of Pest

R’ Shimon (Simon) ben David Oppenheim — Raavad of Pest (c. 1749/1753 - 1851)

Who he was. Rabbi Shimon ben David Oppenheim was the **Raavad** (rosh av beis din — senior dayan / head of the rabbinical court) of the **Pest** community for roughly half a century. Born in **Boskovice (Boskowitz), Moravia**, son of R’ David “Kromau” (Krumlov), he studied under **R’ Benjamin Wolf of Boskowitz** (av beis din of Kolín and Prostějov), taught in **Prague** in the late 18th century, then in **Freistadt from c. 1793**, and was appointed a dayan in **Pest in 1801**. The **Oppenheim** surname came not from the famous R’ David Oppenheim of Prague but through his father-in-law/uncle **R’ Yehuda Leib (Löb) Oppenheim of Freistadt**, whose name he adopted. (Sources: Jewish Encyclopedia, “Oppenheim, Simon ben David”; Hebrew & English Wikipedia on his son R’ Avrohom Chaim Oppenheim; Appel Auction primary-document lots.)

Disambiguation: he is **not** R’ David Oppenheim of Prague (1664–1736, the bibliophile chief rabbi). And the protégé English Wikipedia loosely calls a “relative,” R’ Avrohom Chaim Oppenheim (rabbi at Pécs, d. young), was in fact his **son**, per Hebrew Wikipedia.

Dates. - Born: **c. 1749 or 1753** (ג'תק"ט / ג'תק"י), in Boskovice. (Jewish Encyclopedia rounds to “1753, Kromau”; Hebrew sources give Boskowitz and the ג'תק"י/ט range.) - Passing / yahrtzeit: **22 Shevat 5611 = 24 January 1851**; reported **age 102**. - Discrepancy flagged & resolved: some Hebrew forum/aggregator text renders the death year as 5571/1811, and garbled auto-summaries give “5671/1911.” Both

are **scribal errors for (1851 / 5611) תרי"א** — refuted by his signed documents dated 1837 and 1839 and by his publishing works in the 1820s, all impossible under an 1811 death. **Print 1851.** - (Sources fetched June 2026: Jewish Encyclopedia; iVelt thread title "כ"ב שבט תרי"א"; Appel Auction lots 250 [1837] and 192 [1839].)

His sefarim. A substantial author and editor. Best-attested (anchored to a library/encyclopedia record): - **Amud HaShachar (עמוד השחר)** — Prague, 1789; his first work (~age 26). - **Har HaKarmel (הר הכרמל)** — Prague, 1812; novellae on the Shach and the Gra on hilchos niddah and mikvaos (HebrewBooks #8117). - **Nezer HaKodesh (נזר הקודש)** — Ofen (Buda), 1831; on middos/ethics (HebrewBooks #30658). - He also brought his late son's works to press: **Har Avel (הר אבל)** (Lemberg, 1824) and **Neshmas Chaim (נשמת חיים)** (Dyhernfurth, 1829). - Further titles named in Hebrew biographies — Sefer HaDa'as / HaModea (on R' Yonasan Eybeschütz's laws of ribbis), Har HaMoriyah and Har HaKedem (chiddushim on hilchos gittin), and a commentary on Sefer HaIttur (said to have appeared at age 92) — rest on Hebrew aggregators/auction catalogues and should be confirmed in a seforim catalogue before print. - (Sources: Jewish Encyclopedia; HebrewBooks #8117, #30658; auction catalogues.)

Stories from his lifetime. 1. A dayan's own hand (documented). Surviving autographs establish his active judicial role and longevity: the closing lines of the will of R' Avraham Yitzchak Katz of Pest in his own hand (**Pest, 1837**) and a tosefes kesubah he signed (**Pest, 1839**), both sold at auction. (Source: Appel Auction lots 250, 192.) 2. A father who buried his son (documented). He outlived his son R' Avrohom Chaim (d. ~age 28) and himself published the young man's two sefarim (1824, 1829). (Sources: Hebrew/English Wikipedia.) 3. The grave found intact (tradition). It is related that in **1971**, when his grave had to be moved for cemetery works, his body and shrouds were found whole — a classic tzaddik motif. **Treat strictly as tradition.** (Source: iVelt thread, via search summary.) 4. Fifty years of service, and a life of 102 years (tradition). Widely repeated; the round figures are traditional, not independently documented.

His Torah — in his own sefarim. Rather than risk misquoting an image-scanned text, no teaching is reproduced here; his recorded Torah is contained in the works listed under His sefarim above — above all the novellae **Har HaKarmel** (Prague, 1812) and the ethical **Nezer HaKodesh** (Buda, 1831). (A tradition holds that he composed a prayer inscribed on his own matzeva that visitors recite; the wording could not be verified.)

His resting place. He is buried in **Budapest**, in what Hebrew sources call the **Neolog section**, his grave described as a place visitors come to pray (tradition). Important caveat for the trip: the exact present-day plot is **uncertain in the secondary sources**. At his 1851 death the Pest community's ground was the **Váci út cemetery** (later Lehel utca), which was **demolished**, its older graves relocated during Budapest's urban regulation of the 1870s-80s — many into the **Salgótarjáni utca** (Neolog) cemetery. A rabbimap.com pin instead places him at the **Kozma utca** (Ortho-

dox) cemetery, but that ground only opened in 1891 and so post-dates him. **Verify the exact plot with the Budapest Jewish community (BZSH) / on the ground before publishing a location.** (Sources: Salgótarjáni Street Jewish Cemetery [Wikipedia]; rabbimap.com; Hebrew sources.)

Research note (June 2026): identity, dates (1851, with 1811/1911 rejected as errors) and the three core sefarim are confirmed across independent source types (encyclopedia, library catalogue, two dated autographs). Still open: the secondary list of additional sefarim; and the **precise grave location** (Salgótarjáni vs. Kozma utca).

Sources & bibliography

This bibliography gathers the works cited inline throughout the book. It mixes three kinds of source: (a) authoritative reference and Holocaust documentation, relied on for history, dates and figures; (b) secondary Jewish-press, biographical and community/traditional material, used for stories and reputation (and labelled in the text where a claim is tradition rather than documented fact); and (c) auction-house catalogues, used mainly for dated primary documents and seforim provenance. The digitised sefarim on HebrewBooks are image scans and should be consulted directly before any teaching is quoted in the final book.

Reference works & encyclopaedias - Encyclopaedia Judaica (consulted via the Jewish Virtual Library and Encyclopedia.com). - The Jewish Encyclopedia (1901-06): "Hungary"; "Oppenheim, Simon ben David" — jewishencyclopedia.com. - YIVO Encyclopedia of Jews in Eastern Europe: "Hungary: Historical Overview" — encyclopedia.yivo.org. - English Wikipedia: "History of the Jews in Hungary"; "Yitzchak Isaac Taub"; "Kaliv (Hasidic dynasty)"; "Yeshayah Steiner"; "Moshe Teitelbaum (Ujhel)"; "Chaim Halberstam"; "Liska / Spinka / Sanz (Hasidic dynasties)"; "Chaim Elazar Spira"; "Moses Sofer"; "Oberlander Jews" / "Unterlander Jews"; "Numerus clausus"; "Status Quo Ante (Hungary)"; "White Terror (Hungary)"; "Labour service in Hungary during World War II"; "Miskolc Synagogue"; "Mád"; "Kunmadaras pogrom"; "Miskolc pogrom"; "Abraham Judah ha-Kohen Schwartz"; "Salgótarjáni Street Jewish Cemetery". - Hebrew Wikipedia / Hamichlol (biographical entries for the Hungarian rabbanim).

Holocaust documentation & community records - United States Holocaust Memorial Museum (USHMM), Holocaust Encyclopedia: "The Holocaust in Hungary"; "Kamenets-Podolsk"; "Budapest"; "Deportation of Hungarian Jews"; "Raoul Wallenberg and the Rescue of Jews in Budapest"; "1944: Key Dates"; "Jewish Losses During the Holocaust: By Country". - Yad Vashem: "Murder of Hungarian Jewry"; "Dispute between the Munkács and Belz Hasidim". - Holocaust Memorial Day Trust (liberation of the Budapest ghetto). - JewishGen: Yizkor Books, Pinkas Hakehillot Hungary, and KehilaLinks (Miskolc, Mád and other kehillas).

Scholarship & Jewish communal organisations - Quest: Issues in Contemporary Jewish History (CDEC), "Jews and Jewishness in Post-war Hungary". - Mária M. Kovács / Central European University (on the 1920 numerus clausus). - World Jewish Congress, "Community in Hungary". - Jewish Telegraphic Agency (JTA).

Jewish press, magazines & Torah sites (secondary; stories/reputation) - Mishpacha; Tablet; The Jerusalem Post; The Times of Israel (cited but page not retrievable — HTTP 403); VINnews; Yeshiva World News (YWN) / Williamsburg365; Baltimore Jewish Life; Jewish History Soundbites (podcast); Boro Park 24; chabad.org; lpitorah.org; toratcha.com; rebshayelev.org; NerTzaddik; and the popular biography Reb Shayelev Kerestirer (Feldheim) and Y. Besser's writing.

Heritage, cemetery & seforim resources - Zsidó Örökség Útja (Jewish Heritage Route, Hungary). - World Monuments Fund (restoration of the Kol Aryeh Synagogue, Mád). - Dohány / Great Synagogue official site (greatsynagogue.hu). - National Library of Israel (NLI) catalogue. - HebrewBooks.org — digitised sefarim (image scans): Yagel Yaakov (#848, #849); Har HaKarmel (#8117); Nezer HaKodesh (#30658); Levushei Mordechai (#786, #55480). - Find a Grave; Geni; kevarim.com; the "Footsteps of the Wonder Rabbis" grave database; rabbimap.com.

Auction houses (dated primary documents & seforim provenance) - Kedem Auctions; Kestenbaum & Co.; Genazym; Appel Auction; Tiferet Auctions; Eichlers; lot-art.